pollution	biodiversity	mycoprotein
toxic	variety	fungus
smoke	species	Fusarium
sewerage	ecosystem	protein
acidic gases	Earth	vegetarian
fertiliser	animals	food

food security	secondary consumers	primary consumers
population	food chain	herbivores
feed	carnivores	food chain
pests	herbivores	producers
crops	eat	plants
enough		eat

decomposers	global warming	apex predator
break down	carbon dioxide	carnivore
decay	temperature	top
dead	methane	pyramid
enzymes	atmosphere	food chain

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Fusarium	photosynthesis	golden rice
fungus mycoprotein vegetarian aerobic	producers chloroplasts carbon dioxide glucose oxygen	GM genetically modified crop plant
producers	**fishing quota**	**peat**
plants trophic algae food chain herbivores	population stocks sustainable conservation control	carbon dioxide bogs land use moss fuel
trophic level	**biomass**	**deforestation**
food chain producers herbivores carnivores biomass	pyramid food chain living material decreases	trees forests land use biofuels crops

Teaching notes

Taboo is a word guessing game. The objective is to have your team guess the keyword on top of a card. This must be accomplished without using the word itself or any of the additional ‘taboo’ (forbidden) words listed on the card.

1. Students work in teams (an even number with at least two people in each team).
2. Each team needs a set of cards. It is worth copying each set onto different coloured paper and/or laminating them to ensure that you have all the cards back at the end of the activity in order to reuse them.
3. The cards need to be cut out, and then shuffled and placed face down.
4. An individual from the first team takes the card from the top of the pile, and then describes the word at the top of the card without using the words below. The rest of their team must guess which word is described. Participants are not allowed to say ‘sounds like’ or ‘rhymes with’ and no gestures, sounds or drawings are permitted.
5. Should the individual use one of the taboo words, a member of the opposing team may challenge and the individual must move on to the next word.
6. Each individual is allowed two minutes to describe as many words as possible to the players in their team (a longer time may be required to allow more descriptions to take place) before play passes to the next team. There are no penalties for a wrong guess.
7. For each word which is correctly guessed, the playing team receives one point. Prizes/merits could be handed out to the winning team in each group.

This activity is designed to extend the students’ vocabulary range by finding other ways to describe the keyword. It allows a review of scientific vocabulary in addition to reinforcing the students’ memory of each scientific term.

In the lesson or homework prior to playing this game, the students could research meanings of new terms.

Further activities

1. Each student is given a blank card to put a keyword onto. They then write a further five associated ‘taboo’ words underneath. Collect the cards and use as a class or group activity.